

COURSE SYLLABUS

ECON 201-008 Spring 2026

Principles of Microeconomics

Course Introduction

Credit Hours: 3

Prerequisite Courses: None

Instructor: Joshua Teye

Class Meets: This class meets: MWF/Time: 9:30 am to 10:20 am/ Venue: **Reynolds Hall 4225.**

Course Introduction: This course introduces WVU students to the principles of microeconomics. Microeconomics studies the behavior of individual entities such as individuals, households, and firms, as well as the interactions between these entities in markets. Almost 100 years ago, the economist Alfred Marshall described microeconomics as the study of men and women in the “everyday business of life.”

General Education Area: This course fulfills 3 credits of general education credits under F4: Society and Connections.

Instructor Contact Information

Instructor Email: jt00064@mix.wvu.edu

Instructor Office Location: Reynolds Hall 5002

Office Hours: I am available for office hours MWF (11:00 am to 12 noon).

You can find the updated office hours for each week under the “LIVE HELP” section in eCampus. All office hours will be held in person. However, if you are unable to meet in person, please email me to request a Zoom link for an online appointment.

Communication Policy: If you have any questions about course policies or your grade at any point during the semester, please use the office hours link on eCampus to attend my office hours during a time listed on the schedule. It is good to meet me directly if you have questions about your grade or course policies rather than send emails back and forth. Please note that I cannot communicate with you about this course over a non-WVU account. Therefore, you must use your name@mix.wvu.edu email address when inquiring about this course.

Ask My Instructor: You will see this option in the text and exercises online. Tentatively, we will have TAs assigned to answer these questions within 24 hours on weekdays.

In addition to office hours, students can contact the course instructor by email at: caw00024@mix.wvu.edu. Before sending email, students should read all instructional material posted to eCampus to find answers to questions that have already been provided. Announcements in eCampus will also be sent as e-mail messages. Students should reply to email messages sent with eCampus announcements whenever appropriate. When sending email, students may expect the following e-mail response times:

- Messages sent during the business week (M-F, 9a-5p), should receive a reply within 24 hours.
- Messages sent during weekends should receive a reply by 5p on Monday.

E-mail messages should never include confidential information such as grades, personal identifying information (PII), or other sensitive material. I cannot offer standing appointments for tutoring. But we have many teaching assistants and undergraduate tutors who provide this service. Please see "LIVE HELP" on eCampus for more information.

Instructional Materials

Required Instructional Materials:

We will use **Microeconomics by Glenn Hubbard and Anthony Patrick O'Brien**. You will access it through eCampus. Instructions to purchase are available under "Get Started". You have the option to delay purchasing for 14 days and still access the materials. If you fail to pay within the 14 days, you can reactivate your account with payment by following the instructions through your email.

This course runs from January 12th, 2026, to May 1st, 2026. This course is composed of 6 Modules. Your section of this course is scheduled over 17 weeks. You can expect to cover a module about every two

- three weeks and have a test at the end of that time period. Each test will cover two to three chapters of material from your text.

Course Learning Outcomes

The course will introduce students to the university-level study of microeconomic principles and the application of those principles to the world around them. Having completed this course:

- 1) Students can investigate economic relationships using graphical analysis.
- 2) Students can state the basic theories behind consumer behavior (demand) and producer behavior (supply) constrained by the scarcity of valuable resources.
- 3) Students can analyze how world events affect market equilibrium prices and quantities using supply and demand.
- 4) Students can describe the role of prices, profit, and loss in coordinating economic activity.
- 5) Students can describe the nature of competition in markets.
- 6) Students can assess the efficiency of competitive market outcomes relative to alternative arrangements.
- 7) Students can outline the theory of the firm and its implications for prices and production under both perfect and imperfect competition, including monopoly.
- 8) Students can perform simple analyses of markets for production inputs, including labor and capital.
- 9) Students can examine the potential roles for government in the economy.
- 10) * Students can explain externalities and where and when they are likely to occur.
- 11) * Students can analyze outcomes associated with government interventions into markets.

*Supports GEF Learning Objectives.

Course Assessment

Homework:

10% of your grade is from homework that are due weekly. You can check the due dates on Pearson MyLab and on eCampus. These assignments will consist of textbook questions that require you to solve exercises both mathematically and graphically, as well as interpret the economic implications of the topics covered in the course.

Grading Adjustment:

If you achieve an overall average of **50% or higher** across all graded assignments in the course, you will receive a final score of **100%** for homework, while the weight of homework will remain at 10% of your total grade.

Class participation:

Class participation accounts for 10% of your final grade and is essential for success in this course. Regular attendance provides opportunities to engage in class discussions, participate in group activities, and stay informed about important announcements. Participation may take various forms, such as quizzes, in-class exercises, or other interactive activities, which can occur at any time during the scheduled class period.

Participation Requirements:

To earn full credit (100%) for class participation, students are expected to participate in at least two-thirds (2/3) of the total sessions.

As the instructor, I reserve the right to modify participation requirements or formats at any point during the semester if necessary.

Additional material beyond lectures, graded homework, and class participation:

Dynamic Study Modules, a Study Plan, and alternate (not for grade) Homework are available to you as part of this course package. Dynamic Study modules help you learn what you don't know. After you do a set of 8 questions, you review the information for the answers you got wrong or didn't know. Then you continue to the next set of 8 questions, and you have a chance to try again on the questions you didn't answer correctly the first time. There are many other sets of readings (AI assisted), videos, practice sets and worksheets to do on your own. You may find that the DSM are more fun if you do a bit of pre-work ahead of time. Each DSM corresponds to a corresponding chapter. These Dynamic Study Modules are a great way to test yourself before you take the exam.

Exams:

The five weekly exams (17-25 questions) will open on Thursday morning at 8:00 AM with the due date of Friday at 4:30 PM in the Hodges Testing Center. You will need to schedule an appointment with the Testing Center. Students should call [\(304\) 293-2169](tel:3042932169) or if seats are not available, email wyutestingcenter@mail.wvu.edu for assistance. More information can be found at <https://testingcenter.wvu.edu/booking>. Once you open the exam, you will have 30 minutes to finish. If your university approved schedule is such that you need to take an exam earlier than scheduled, check with me. Late exams are not permitted, university sanctioned emergencies withstanding.

Final Exam:

The final exam (50 questions) is officially scheduled according to the university calendar: <https://registrar.wvu.edu/calendars/final-examination-schedule>. However, we are working on scheduling a wider window with the testing center. You will have an hour to take the final exam. The semester ends on the Friday of exam week. Grades will be calculated over the weekend. I will post grades by 11:00 AM on May 11th, 2026.

Extra Credit:

TEL – Test of Economic Literacy Quiz:

As an extra credit opportunity, you will participate in the Test of Economic Literacy (TEL) Quiz, a two-part assessment designed to measure your knowledge of economics before and after the course. **The pre-test must be completed at the Hodges Testing Center by Friday, January 16th, 2026.** This quiz is not graded on performance, and no studying is required, as it is solely intended to assess your baseline understanding of economics. **Completing the pre-test will earn you 1 point of extra credit toward your final grade.** At the end of the course, you will have the opportunity to take a post-test quiz, which will assess your knowledge after completing the class. To be eligible for the post-test, you must have completed the pre-test. **Successfully completing the post-test will earn you an additional 1 point of extra credit on your final grade, for a total of 2 extra credit points available.** Both quizzes are optional but provide an easy way to boost your grade while gauging your learning progress.

Weight/Distribution of Course Points:

Possible points	
Homework	20%
Class participation	20%
Tests 1 – 5	10% each, 40%
Final Exam - Comprehensive	20%
Total	100%

NOTE ON MIDTERMS

Approximately 40% of the grade will be used to determine the midterm grade. This is comprised of material from the first two modules.

Expected Timeline of Major Assignments/Assessments and Topics/Units:

	Week	TOPICS	Material from text	Dynamic Study Modules	Tests
Module 1	1	Orientation	Chapter 0	0	Test of Economic Literacy Quiz – Jan 13-17
TEST 1 Jan 12 – 30	2	Foundations	Chapter 1	1	
	3	Tradeoffs	Chapter 2	2	Test 1 – Jan 29/30 Chapters 1 & 2
Module 2	4/5	Demand and Supply and the interaction	Chapter 3	3	
TEST 2 Jan 21 – Feb 20	5/6	What markets can do and how they can be affected by policy	Chapter 4	4	Test 2 – Feb 19/20 Chapters 3 & 4
Module 3	7/8	Externalities	Chapter 5	5	
TEST 3 Feb 21 – March 13	8/9	Elasticity	Chapter 6	6	Test 3 – March 12/13 Chapters 5 & 6
March 14-22		<i>SPRING BREAK</i>			
Module 4	10	Comp Advantage, Gains from Trade	Chapter 9	9	
TEST 4 March 23 – April 3	11/12	Deeper Dive – Firm Technology and Cost	Chapter 11	11	Test 4 – April 2/3 Chapters 9 & 11
Module 5	13	Competition	Chapter 12	12	
TEST 5 April 4 – 24	14	Monopolistic Competition	Chapter 13	13	
	15	Oligopoly	Chapter 14	14	Test 5 – April 23/24 Chapters 12,13,14
Module 6 April 25 – May 1	16	Monopoly	Chapter 15	15	Included on the final exam
	17	Final Exam , Comprehensive, All Modules Schedule: May 4-8. Must be completed by Friday at 4:30 PM Official Schedule confirmed here: https://registrar.wvu.edu/calendars/final-examination-schedule			

Grading Scale:

The course grade will be assigned with the following distribution. You will be able to see a running average your grade as dynamic study modules and exams are graded.

Grade	
90% and above	A
80% - 89.9%	B
70% - 79.9%	C
60% - 69.9%	D
less than 59.9%	F

Course and Institutional Policies

Attendance Policy:

Attending class helps you learn and succeed in this course, and it counts toward 10% of your grade (see class participation above). If you miss a class for any reason, it is your responsibility to catch up on the missed work.

Missed Exam Policy:

All the materials for this course are posted in advance, and only sanctioned absences will be considered for early release of materials/exams. **There are no late assignments accepted.**

Academic Integrity:

The following free tutorials allow students to better understand academic integrity at WVU. If you are unfamiliar with WVU policies concerning Academic Integrity, the University has produced some free, easy-to-follow tutorials.

- [WVU Academic Integrity Tutorial](#)
- [WVU Plagiarism Avoidance Tutorial](#)

Appropriate Use of Technology Statement

Use of technology in the classroom should always be directly related to class activities and/or course learning outcomes. Inappropriate technology use can be an impediment to learning and a distraction to all members of the class. As such, inappropriate use of technology in the classroom may be considered a disruption of the class and constitute a violation of the [WVU Student Conduct Code](#) and could potentially result in a referral to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities. Use of technology in the classroom when specifically prohibited by the instructor may also constitute a violation of WVU's [Academic Integrity](#) policy.

Artificial Intelligence Syllabus Statement

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools that can create and develop academic content are not allowed unless permission is given by an instructor. Students must receive instructor permission prior to utilizing AI tools. Unauthorized use of AI tools may result in academic dishonesty charges.

ACCOMODATIONS: <https://osa.wvu.edu/about>

Accommodations are provided in accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, as well as other state and federal laws. If you have academic accommodations be sure to forward this information to your instructor.

Attendance policy

Students are responsible for notifying their instructors of expected university sanctioned absences within two weeks of the event or as soon as possible. Instructors may require written documentation in advance of the university sanctioned absence from the academic or athletic unit sponsoring the activity for students participating in official activities. Instructors may request additional verification from the [Center for Veteran, Military, and Family Programs website](#) for students serving military obligation.

Institutional Policies:

Students are responsible for reviewing [policies](#) on inclusivity, academic integrity, incompletes, sale of course materials, sexual misconduct, adverse weather, as well as student evaluation of instruction, and days of special concern/religious holiday statements.

Instructor's Authority and Flexibility

Please note that I reserve the right to make decisions and adjustments regarding course policies, assignments, and grading as necessary to ensure the best learning experience for all students. While this syllabus provides a framework for the course, my decisions are final and may supersede any information not explicitly stated in the syllabus. It is your responsibility to stay informed of any updates or changes announced in class or through course communications.